

Lab: The Paper Toss

Goal

To use Feedback to improve your aim (Motor Learning).

What You Need

- A trash can or bucket.
- 5 sheets of scrap paper (crumpled into balls).

Steps

1. The Setup

Put the bucket on one side of the room. Stand 5 steps away.

2. The First Toss

Throw one paper ball. Where did it go?

- Too short? (Error: Need more power).
- Too Left? (Error: Aim right).

3. The Adjustment

Throw the second ball. Use the data from the first throw! If it was short, throw HARDER.

4. The Streak

Try to get 3 in a row. Once you get it, move back 2 steps! (Make it harder).

Discussion

- Did you get better?

- Your brain was doing complex math (Trajectory/Force) without you knowing it.
- The "Error" (Missing) taught you how to "Hit."

What We Learned

You don't need a coach to learn. You just need to pay attention to your mistakes and adjust.